MONTHLY CURRENT AFFAIRS CAPSULE

March 2026

Exam-ready tables, quick facts and practice MCQs — compiled from 4,031 official headlines (PIB, RBI, All India Radio).

9 Appointments	**4** Defence exercises	**8** Summits & meets	**2** Awards
4 Sports wins	**14** Important days	**15** Practice MCQs	

★ 10 must-know facts this month

1. SUMMIT
   7th India–Japan CEPA Joint Committee Meeting
   Tokyo

2. EXERCISE
   Lamitiye
   India × Seychelles

3. APPOINTED
   B.P. Singh
   Director General of Naval Armament

4. SPORTS
   Sumit Antil
   Gold · Javelin throw at World Para Athletics Grand Prix in New Delhi

5. MOU
   India × Bhutan
   Postal Cooperation

6. SUMMIT
   9th International Santal Conference
   Darjeeling

7. EXERCISE
   Freedom Shield
   India × USA × South Korea

8. APPOINTED
   Balendra Shah
   Prime Minister of Nepal

9. SPORTS
   Squash: Defending champion Anahat Singh
   Women's Singles title · Indian Open in Mumbai

10. SUMMIT
    14th National People's Congress
    Beijing

EX Defence exercises 4

💡 Asked as: “Exercise X is held between India and …?” — remember name ↔ partner country (↔ service: Army/Navy/Air Force).

EXERCISE	WITH INDIA	WHERE
Lamitiye	Seychelles	—
Freedom Shield	USA, South Korea	—
Amogh Jwala	India (own forces)	—
IMEX	India (own forces)	Southern Naval

SU Summits, conferences & meetings 8

💡 Asked as: “Where was the nth … Summit held?” — learn edition number ↔ host city/country.

EVENT	VENUE
7th India–Japan CEPA Joint Committee Meeting	Tokyo
Raisina Dialogue 2026	New Delhi
11th edition of Raisina Dialogue	New Delhi
9th International Santal Conference	Darjeeling
14th National People’s Congress	Beijing
13th National Parliament Session	Dhaka
14th Ministerial Conference	Cameroon
29th National Session	Nagpur

AP Appointments 9

💡 Asked as: “Who has been appointed as …?” — learn the name ↔ post pair, and whether it is a first (first woman, first from…).

WHO	POST
B.P. Singh	Director General of Naval Armament
Dr. Partha Biswas	Member of the National Commission for Scheduled Castes (NCSC)
Krishna Kumar Thakur	Director (Personnel), NMDC
T.N. Natarajan	Director (Commercial) of SAIL

WHO	POST
PM Modi Becomes Longest-Serving	Head of Government in India
Balendra Shah	Prime Minister of Nepal
Sadhvi Niranjan Jyoti	Chairperson of NCBC
Tom Suozzi	Vice-Chair of Congressional Caucus on India and Indian Americans
Uchral Nyam-Osor	Mongolia's new Prime Minister

AW Awards & honours 2

💡 Asked as: "Who won the … award/prize?" — Nobel, Booker and national awards are favourites.

AWARD	WINNER
Union Minister Dr Jitendra Singh Conferred Lifetime Achievement Award in Medicine & Diabetes at Chennai National Medical Meet; this is the second Lifetime Achievement Award for medical excellence	him
Grand Prize	Telangana Culture Minister Jupally Krishna Rao

SP Sports 4

💡 Asked as: "Who won gold/the title at …?" — athlete ↔ event ↔ medal.

WHO	WON	EVENT
India	ICC Men's T20 World Cup Title	—
Sumit Antil	Gold	Javelin throw at World Para Athletics Grand Prix in New Delhi
Squash: Defending champion Anahat Singh	Women's Singles title	Indian Open in Mumbai
Pramod Bhagat	gold	—

DY Important days 14

💡 Asked as: "… Day is observed on?" and "What was this year's theme?" — learn date + theme.

DATE	DAY	THEME
28 February	National Science Day	—
reported 01/03	National Physical Laboratory Celebrates National Science Day	—
3 March	World Wildlife Day	—
8 March	International Women's Day	—
reported 12/03	International Day of Yoga-2026	—
reported 12/03	World Kidney Day	—
reported 20/03	World Oral Health Day	—
20 March	World Sparrow Day	—
21 March	International Day of Forests	—
22 March	World Water Day	—
29 June	National Statistics Day	—
23 March	World Meteorological Day	—
24 March	World Tuberculosis Day	—
24 March	World TB Day	—

MO Agreements & MoUs 1

💡 Asked as: "India signed an MoU on … with which country?" — partner country ↔ area.

COUNTRY	AREA
Bhutan	Postal Cooperation

SC Schemes, portals & initiatives 20

💡 Asked as: "Which ministry launched …?" — scheme/portal ↔ ministry.

WHAT	BY
Version 2.0 of the Indian Culture Portal	Ministry of Culture
upgraded version of Indian Culture Portal at Kartavya Bhawan	Culture Ministry
Holistic Homestay Support Framework	Ladakh Tourism Department
Logo Design Contest on MyGov portal	Rural Development Ministry
Bug Bounty Programme to Further Strengthen Aadhaar Security	Ministry of Electronics & IT

WHAT	BY
Upgraded Version of National Youth Parliament Scheme Web Portal	Ministry of Parliamentary Affairs
second annual edition of “Fiscal Health Index”	NITI Aayog
first structured bug bounty programme to strengthen Aadhaar System Security	UIDAI
on UMEED Central Portal to Strengthen Financial Governance of Waqf Institutions	Ministry of Minority Affairs
upgraded version of the National Youth Parliament Scheme web portal, known as NYPS 2.0	Ministry of Parliamentary Affairs
5G Innovation Hackathon 2026 under 100 5G Use Case Labs Initiative	Ministry of Communications
‘PRARAMBH 2026’	Ministry of Finance
Credit Guarantee Scheme for Microfinance Institutions-2.0 (CGSMFI-2.0)	Ministry of Finance
Indian Carbon Market Portal, Reinforces India’s Climate Commitments	Ministry of Power
Real-Time Internal Audit Portal to Revolutionize Governance and Oversight	Ministry of Rural Development
National AI Skilling Initiative, My WAVES, in built TV Tuner and Advanced EPG	Union Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw
Twin Initiatives DDKY and National Mission on Natural Farming to Boost Productivity, Sustainability and Farmer Welfare	Ministry of Agriculture & Farmers Welfare
3-Month Internship Programme for Graduates and Postgraduates	National Biodiversity Authority
Gruh Sugam Portal focusing on Defence, Paramilitary & Government Personnel	Ministry of Finance
at DISHA Programme	Ministry of Electronics & IT

CB Cabinet decisions 17

💡 Banking & UPSC ask the numbers: outlay (₹ crore), number of projects/schools, the year.

changes in guidelines on investments from countries sharing land border with India

Declaration of Madurai Airport, Tamil Nadu, as an International Airport

extension of Jal Jeevan Mission (JJM) period up to December 2028 with enhanced outlay and restructured implementation focusing on structural reforms in rural drinking water supply sector under JJM 2.0

Revised Cost estimate for the Construction of Greenfield Connectivity to Jewar International Airport from Delhi-Faridabad-Ballabhgarh-Sohna Spur of the Delhi-Mumbai Expressway on Hybrid Annuity Mode in U...

construction of 4 Lanning of Badnawar-Petlawad-Thandla-Timarwani section of (NH-752D) of Delhi Mumbai expressway in Madhya Pradesh on Hybrid Annuity Mode worth Rs.3,839.42 crore

two multitracking projects covering 5 Districts of West Bengal and Jharkhand, increasing the existing network of Indian Railways by about 192 Kms

extension of Jal Jeevan Mission up to December 2028

scheme on 'Small Hydro Power (SHP) Development Scheme for the period FY 2026-27 to FY 2030-31'

a New Era of Plug-and-Play Industrial Development through Bharat Audyogik Vikas Yojna (BHAVYA)

construction of 4-Lane Access-Controlled National Highway-927 from Barabanki to Bahraich (101.515 km) in Uttar Pradesh on Hybrid Annuity Mode at a cost of Rs.6969.04 crore

MSP funding of Rs.1,718.56 crore to CCI for cotton seasons 2023-24 for direct support to cotton farmers

New Era of Industrial Development through Bharat Audyogik Vikas Yojna

India's Nationally Determined Contribution (2031-2035) to be communicated to the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change

Regional Connectivity Scheme – Modified UDAN with a total outlay of Rs.28,840 crore

Continuation of the Immigration, Visa, Foreigners Registration & Tracking (IVFRT) Scheme

Modified UDAN to Deepen Regional Connectivity and Expand Inclusive Air Access Across India

India's Commitment to Reduce Emissions Intensity of its GDP by 47% by 2035

₹ Banking corner (RBI)

💡 Banking exams: which bank was penalised / whose licence was cancelled, and RBI's new rules.

Licence cancelled (2)

- Shimsha Sahakara Bank Niyamitha, Maddur, Mandya District, Karnataka
- 36 NBFCs

Monetary penalty imposed on (18)

- Samruddhi Sahakari Bank Ltd., Nandgaon, Nashik, Maharashtra
- Maanaveeya Development & Finance Private Limited
- Walchandnagar Sahakari Bank Ltd., Walchandnagar, Maharashtra

- The Pallikonda Co-operative Urban Bank Limited, Tamil Nadu
- Manappuram Finance Limited
- The Hongkong and Shanghai Banking Corporation Limited
- The Tanur Co-operative Urban Bank Limited, Kerala
- The Kodagu District Co-operative Central Bank Limited, Karnataka
- The Mysore and Chamarajnagar District Co-operative Central Bank Limited, Karnataka
- Vedvyas Finance Private Limited, Odisha
- Loknete R.D. Appa, Kshirsagar Sahakari Bank Ltd., Niphad, Maharashtra
- The Pali District Central Co-operative Bank Ltd., Rajasthan
- Union Bank of India
- Bank of India
- Pine Labs Limited
- Central Bank of India
- The Davanagere District Central Co-operative Bank Limited, Karnataka
- Nagar Sahakari Bank Limited, Etawah, Uttar Pradesh

Fast facts by topic

Banking & Economy

- India targeting major expansion in exports of sports goods from over 3,000 crore to over 80,000 crore: Secretary of Sports Hari Ranjan Rao
- Inflation in Euro zone soars past European Central Bank's 2% target as surging oil & gas costs
- Sri Lanka's inflation remains modest in March 2026, according to Colombo CPI
- RBI postpones implementation of new rules on capital market exposure by 3 months
- FM Nirmala Sitharaman asserts, fundamentals of Indian economy are strong
- Banks in country operate under strict legal, regulatory framework to ensure safety of customers' data: FM Sitharaman
- Government of India is taking measures to promote adoption of Artificial Intelligence (AI) and digital technologies among MSMEs
- Ministry of MSME implements various initiatives to support enterprises and boost competitiveness in domestic and international markets

Defence & Security

- Indian Navy receives Malwan, second Anti-Submarine Warfare Shallow Water Craft
- UAE Air defence systems remain on high alert after fresh wave of Iranian missile & drone launches intercepted
- Japan deploys its first long-range missile at two of its bases in country
- Defence Ministry signs 1950 crore contract with Bharat Electronics Limited
- GRSE delivers 3 frontline Naval platforms to Indian Navy
- Indigenous Stealth Frigate 'Dunagiri' Delivered to Indian Navy – a Major Boost to Aatmanirbharta in Warship Building
- Fourth Survey Vessel (LARGE) 'Sanshodhak' Delivered to Indian Navy at Grse Kolkata
- Indian Naval Ship Trikand Concludes Port Call at Maputo, Mozambique

Science & Technology

- PM inaugurates Samrat Samprati Museum at Koba; Kaynes Semiconductor OSAT plant in Sanand, Gujarat
- NASA completes final preparations for its Artemis II mission, set to launch from Kennedy Space Center
- India is now set to begin new phase of technology-driven organic agriculture: Nitin Gadkari
- Scientists from RRI investigate rare bursts of energy from mysterious space objects
- CSIR Transfers Indigenous Bio-Bitumen Technology: Turning Farm Residue into Sustainable Roads
- Ayurveda Research Accessible in 13 Languages: CCRAS Signs MoU with Anuvadini AI
- Israel intensifies strikes on Iran's nuclear, industrial sites; tensions escalate
- Israeli air strikes hit Iran's nuclear facilities as conflict escalates

Sports

- Day seven of Khelo India Tribal Games features multiple sports competitions
- India's Priya records dominant 5-Nil victory on second day of tournament at Ulaanbaatar in Mongolia
- Defending champions India to take on Bhutan in semi-finals of SAFF U20 Championship at National Stadium in Male
- 16th Hockey India Sub Junior Women National Championship 2026 commences tomorrow in Ranchi, Jharkhand
- IPL 2026: Rajasthan Royals defeat Chennai Super Kings at Barsapara Cricket Stadium, Guwahati
- " From Heritage to High Performance": Smt. Raksha Nikhil Khadse Says Khelo India Tribal Games is Building Champions from India's Tribal Heartland
- Asian Games bronze medallists Preeti Pawar & Deepak register contrasting victories to begin India's campaign on positive note
- Khelo India Tribal Games: Karnataka continue to lead medal tally with 15 gold medals

Awards & Honours

- NHAI Awards Contract for Construction of Flyovers and Underpasses at Jaipur Bypass Junction on NH-48
- NHAI Awards Contract for Four Laning of Gudebellur to Mahabubnagar Section of NH-167 in Telangana
- 'People's Padma' on Akashvani Features Padma Shri Awardee Mahendra Kumar Mishra from Odisha
- Bangladesh: At Least 18 Dead as Passenger Bus Plunges into Padma Riverdia-Paturia Route
- Passenger bus falls into Padma River at Daulatdia Ferry Terminal in Bangladesh
- NHAI Awards Contract for Construction of South–East Bypass for Azamgarh City in Uttar Pradesh
- Akashvani features Shri Chiranji Lal Yadav, skilled artisan known for engraving work, to be honoured with Padma Shri
- 98th Academy Awards concludes; One Battle After Another wins Best Picture

International Relations

- Foreign Secretary Vikram Misri holds Foreign Office Consultations with Russian Deputy Foreign Minister Andrey Rudenko
- DGCA and GSV sign MoU to train youth in broad areas of Aviation
- India condemn attacks on UN peacekeepers in southern Lebanon
- EAM Dr S Jaishankar holds meeting with members of European Parliament
- From Vision to Scale: Union Minister Shri Jayant Chaudhary Highlights India's Outcomes-Based Approach at OFA Summit 2026 Cape Town
- Gati Shakti Vishwavidyalaya & DGCA Sign MoU to Revamp Aircraft Maintenance & Create Jobs
- DGCA signs MoU with Gati Shakti Vishwavidyalaya to train youth in broad areas of Aviation, including Aviation Engineering and Aviation Management
- PM Modi Holds Talks with Saudi Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman on West Asia Conflict

Polity & Governance

- Israel's Parliament passed law imposing death penalty on Palestinians convicted of fatal attacks
- Israel's Parliament passes law approving death penalty on Palestinians convicted of murdering Israelis
- Lok Sabha Speaker Hails Purvanchal's Cultural Heritage at 'Maati - 9' Festival
- President Murmu to visit Bihar and Karnataka starting tomorrow
- Lok Sabha passes Insolvency & Bankruptcy Code Amendment Bill to address procedural delays & interpretational issues among stakeholders
- Rajya Sabha takes up Central Armed Police Forces Bill, 2026, for consideration and passing
- Leader of House in Rajya Sabha J P Nadda accuses Congress, I.N.D.I.A. bloc of practicing appeasement politics
- Bihar Chief Minister Nitish Kumar resigns as MLC after being elected to Rajya Sabha

Appointments

- Balendra Shah Sworn in as Nepal's Youngest Democratically Elected Prime Minister
- Senior diplomat Vikram Doraiswami appointed as India's next ambassador to China
- Capacity Building of Elected Panchayat Representatives
- Govt to organise National Conference of Women Elected Representatives of Panchayats
- MoPR to Host National Conference of Women Elected Representatives under Sashakt Panchayat-Netri Abhiyan on 11th March 2026
- Senior Iranian cleric Ayatollah Alireza Arafi named as country's interim Supreme Leader after killing of Ayatollah Ali Khamenei in joint US-Israeli airstrikes.

Environment

- Impact of Increasing Renewable Energy Penetration on Grid Stability
- From Forest to Fashion
- Strategies to Protect Farmers from Climate Change
- India’s Solar Module Manufacturing Capacity Rises from 3 GW to 172 GW: Union Minister Pralhad Joshi
- PM Surya Ghar Yojana Drives Energy Transition: 9.56 GW Rooftop Solar Capacity Added till March 2026
- National Innovations in Climate Resilient Agriculture Maps Climate Risk in 651 Districts; 310 Found Vulnerable, Climate-Resilient Farming Scaled Across India
- Strengthening Transmission Infrastructure for Integration of Renewable Energy
- National Biodiversity Authority forms panel to address invasive alien species

Schemes & Initiatives

- NASA prepares for Artemis II: First crewed Moon Mission in over 50 years
- Sādhana Saptah 2026: India's Largest collaborative Capacity Building Initiative Begins on 2nd April
- Launch of First Next Generation Offshore Patrol Vessel (Yard 1280, Shachi) at M/S Gsl, Goa
- The 14th Ministerial Conference of the WTO concluded on March 30, 2026 in Yaounde, Cameroon.
- Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi inaugurates Samrat Samprati Museum at Koba Tirth in Gandhinagar On the occasion of Mahavir Jayanti
- English rendering of PM’s speech during the inauguration of Samrat Samprati Museum in Gandhinagar, Gujarat
- Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi inaugurates the Kaynes Semicon Plant at Sanand, Gujarat
- English rendering of PM’s speech during inauguration of the Kaynes Semicon Plant at Sanand, Gujarat

Important Days

- Dept of Personnel & Training, Capacity Building Commission & Karmayogi Bharat to organise week-long Sadhna Saptah: Member Admin, CBC, Dr Alka Mittal
- NESTS to celebrate 8th Foundation Day tomorrow at Dr Ambedkar International Centre in New Delhi
- NESTS to Celebrate 8th Foundation Day on April 1, Showcasing Achievements of EMRS
- PM Modi pays tribute to freedom fighter Shyamji Krishna Varma on his death anniversary
- Prime Minister pays homage to Shyamji Krishna Varma on his death anniversary
- Govt Dismisses Viral Claim of 5–10 Day Oil Reserves in India
- MoS Kirti Vardhan Singh Attends Bangladesh National Day Reception in New Delhi
- Bangladesh Marks 56th Independence and National Day, Honouring 1971 Liberation War Heroes

Practice MCQs (15)

Exam-style questions. Tap an option to check yourself instantly.

Q1. **Who took charge as Director (Personnel), NMDC in March 2026?**

- A Krishna Kumar Thakur
- B D K Shivakumar
- C Hari Shankar Verma
- D Shashi Shekhar Vempati

Q2. **Who won gold at Javelin throw at World Para Athletics Grand Prix in New Delhi in March 2026?**

- A Pranjali Dhumal
- B Gurpreet Singh
- C Magnus Carlsen
- D Sumit Antil

Q3. **Who was sworn in as Prime Minister of Nepal in March 2026?**

- A Balendra Shah
- B Nitish Kumar
- C Jitendra Prasad Sonal
- D Sadhvi Niranjan Jyoti

Q4. **Exercise Lamitiye (March 2026) was held between India and which country?**

- A UK
- B Seychelles
- C Netherlands
- D Japan

Q5. **Where was Exercise IMEX held in March 2026?**

- A Southern Naval
- B Chennai, Tamil
- C Air Force
- D Kuala Lumpur

Q6. **Where was the Raisina Dialogue 2026 held?**

- A New Delhi
- B Southern Naval
- C Raipur, Chhattisgarh
- D Joint Military

Q7. **Who took charge as Director (Commercial) of SAIL in March 2026?**

- A Andy Burnham
- B T.N. Natarajan
- C Divakar Jayant
- D Tarun Kumar Pithode

Q8. **Where was the 11th edition of Raisina Dialogue held?**

- A Bharat Mandapam
- B Pokhran Range
- C Air Force
- D New Delhi

Q9. **Who won the Union Minister Dr Jitendra Singh Conferred Lifetime Achievement Award in Medicine & Diabetes at Chennai National Medical Meet; this is the second Lifetime Achievement Award for medical excellence?**

- A C-DOT
- B ICMR
- C him
- D ICMR-MINDS

Q10. **India signed an MoU/agreement on "Postal Cooperation" with which country in March 2026?**

- A Bhutan
- B Netherlands
- C Egypt
- D Maldives

Q11. **Who took charge as Director General of Naval Armament in March 2026?**

A Divakar Jayant
B B.P. Singh
C Jitendra Prasad Sonal
D Sunetra Pawar

Q12. **Who took charge as Member of the National Commission for Scheduled Castes (NCSC) in March 2026?**

A Justice Surya Kant
B Hagrama Mohilary
C D K Shivakumar
D Dr. Partha Biswas

Q13. **Who was elected as Head of Government in India in March 2026?**

A Supreme Court Chief Andras Baka
B Vice Admiral Vineet McCarty
C PM Modi Becomes Longest-Serving
D Air Marshal Seethepalli Shrinivas

Q14. **Where was the 9th International Santal Conference held?**

A Darjeeling
B Zanzibar
C IIPM
D Milwauke

Q15. **Where was the 7th India–Japan CEPA Joint Committee Meeting held?**

A Chandigarh
B Dhaka
C Tokyo
D Kerala

Answer key

1-A 2-D 3-A 4-B 5-A 6-A 7-B 8-D 9-C 10-A 11-B 12-D 13-C 14-A 15-C

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